



Civic Meeting Report

08-26-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TloYpBC0r4c
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Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Education was called to order by the presiding officer, opening with a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance [00:03:03](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heer, Dr. Washford, Mr. Low, Mr. Urban, and Dr. Reynolds [00:03:37](#)
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Board President (unnamed in text).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance [00:03:03](#). Superintendent Dr. Reynolds highlighted recent educator and staff achievements, including NAACP recognitions for Isaac Dennon and Aisha Allen, the Vivian Conley Awards honoring Tara Gudger and Roseli, and the launch of the Ball State/MCS teacher leadership pipeline cohort [00:03:53](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text).*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:10:48](#) **Consent Agenda Items**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine items presented in board packets. No questions or major debates raised by the board.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (subsequently clarified for the record that no opposition was registered).
- [00:11:31](#) **Monthly Financial Report (July)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durham, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Durham reported that the ADM student count remains stable above 4,800, the state basic grant for July was received, and payroll/benefits remain below previous SSC contract costs. The July ending cash balance was over \$33 million, and the state loan was reduced to \$6.6 million. Fourth-quarter appropriations will tighten as planned, managed through the operation and rainy day funds.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:13:49](#).
- [00:15:57](#) **Public Hearing: 2026 Annual Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durham, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The administration presented the advertised 2026 budget figures: Debt Service (\$10.5 million), Education Fund (\$43.6 million), Operation Fund (\$12.3 million), and Rainy Day Fund (\$1.802 million), with corresponding tax levies. The budget will be formally adopted at the September 9th board meeting.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Several Muncie Central High School seniors (Dorian, Chris, Gabriel, and another student) attended and spoke during the budget hearing, raising questions and concerns regarding outdated library books/lack of foreign language funding, class sizes, and staffing levels.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Public hearing conducted; no formal vote required at this stage.

- **00:34:40 Public Hearing & Resolutions: Project 2025 General Obligation Bonds & Additional Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durham, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board held a public hearing for a proposed \$19.8 million General Obligation bond project (to be sold in phases in late 2025 and 2026). Funds will be allocated for capital improvements, including a new boiler building and air conditioning at the Muncie Fieldhouse, a new chiller at North Side Middle School, exterior doors and flooring at Muncie Central High School, tennis court and track resurfacing, and approximately 50,000 square feet of district-wide roofing.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None directly addressing the bond appropriation from the general public during the formal hearing window.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Additional Appropriation Resolution: Adopted by Voice Vote **00:39:26**.
 - Final Bond Resolution: Adopted by Voice Vote **00:40:12**.
- **00:40:35 Contract Award: Construction Manager as Constructor (CMc)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durham / Brian (Core Construction representative).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Administration recommended awarding the CMc contract for the \$19.8 million bond project to Core Construction (partnering with CGA Associates of Indianapolis), noting past successful collaborations. Core Construction clarified that they do not self-perform trade work, instead bidding out packages for best value.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:42:43**.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

*(Note: While a formal public forum did not occur at the end of the meeting, student participants spoke extensively during the budget public hearing **00:17:48** on educational resources, library funding, and class sizes as detailed under Section 4).*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Reynolds noted that enrollment trends are cautiously optimistic, currently trending slightly above previous counts at 4,892 (unofficial).
 - Upcoming major football game against Yorktown scheduled for Friday at 7:00 PM at the stadium complex, featuring recognition of MCS alumni staff and new hires.
 - Strategic plan updates are nearing completion and expected to be presented to the board in September.

- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote following a motion [00:49:08](#).

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